Keel Labs

Company Overview Keel Labs is an American materials science company that creates sustainable textiles for the fashion industry. Their main goal is to transform the apparel world by making high-quality yarn out of ocean kelp, offering an eco-friendly alternative to both toxic synthetics and resource-heavy natural fibers.



ESG Focus: Kelp-Based Textiles (Kelson™ Fiber)

Why (The Problem) Traditional textile production is highly damaging to the environment. Polyester is made from fossil fuels and sheds microplastics, while natural cotton requires massive amounts of freshwater, pesticides, and arable land. The fashion industry desperately needs a fiber that doesn't deplete land or water resources.

How (The Solution) Keel Labs produces a signature yarn called "Kelson™" using biopolymers extracted from kelp (seaweed). Kelp is one of the fastest-growing organisms on Earth and absorbs carbon dioxide as it grows in the ocean. The company harvests this kelp sustainably and processes it into a versatile, spin-yarn fiber using clean, water-based chemistry.

What (The Outcome) This creates an "Ocean-Born" fiber that matches the strength and softness of traditional materials. Unlike polyester, Kelson™ is fully biodegradable and leaves zero microplastics behind. Because it is grown in the ocean, its production uses no agricultural land, no fresh water, and no harmful pesticides.

Impact: Keel Labs is working with global fashion brands to integrate kelp-based yarn into mass production. By replacing land-grown and fossil-fuel-based fabrics, they are helping the apparel industry lower its carbon footprint and protect vital land ecosystems.